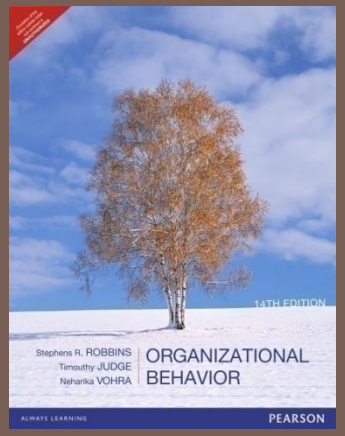


ORGANIZATIONAL BEHAVIOR

Personality and Values

Reference: Robbins, Judge, and Vohra Organizational Behavior, 14th Edition
Dorling Kindersley (India) Pvt. Ltd, Authorized adaptation from the United States edition of *Organizational Behavior, 14e*

Chapter Learning Objectives

- After studying this chapter, you should be able to:
  - Define personality, describe how it is measured, and explain the factors that determine an individual's personality.
  - Describe the Myers-Briggs Type Indicator personality framework and assess its strengths and weaknesses.
  - Identify the key traits in the Big Five personality model.
  - Demonstrate how the Big Five traits predict behavior at work.
  - Identify other personality traits relevant to OB.
  - Define values, demonstrate their importance, and contrast terminal and instrumental values.
  - Compare generational differences in values, and identify the dominant values in today's workforce.
  - Identify Hofstede's six value dimensions of national culture.

What Is Personality?

The dynamic organization within the individual of those psychophysical systems that determine his unique adjustments to his environment. - *Gordon Allport*

- The sum total of ways in which an individual reacts and interacts with others, the measurable traits a person exhibits

- Measuring Personality
  - Helpful in hiring decisions
  - Most common method: self-reporting surveys
  - Observer-ratings surveys provide an independent assessment of personality – often better predictors

Personality Determinants

- Heredity
  - Factors determined at conception: physical stature (figure), facial attractiveness, gender, temperament, (character), muscle composition and reflexes, energy level, and bio-rhythms
  - This “heredity approach” argues that genes are the source of personality
  - Twin studies: raised apart but very similar personalities
  - There is some personality change over long time periods

Personality Traits (character)

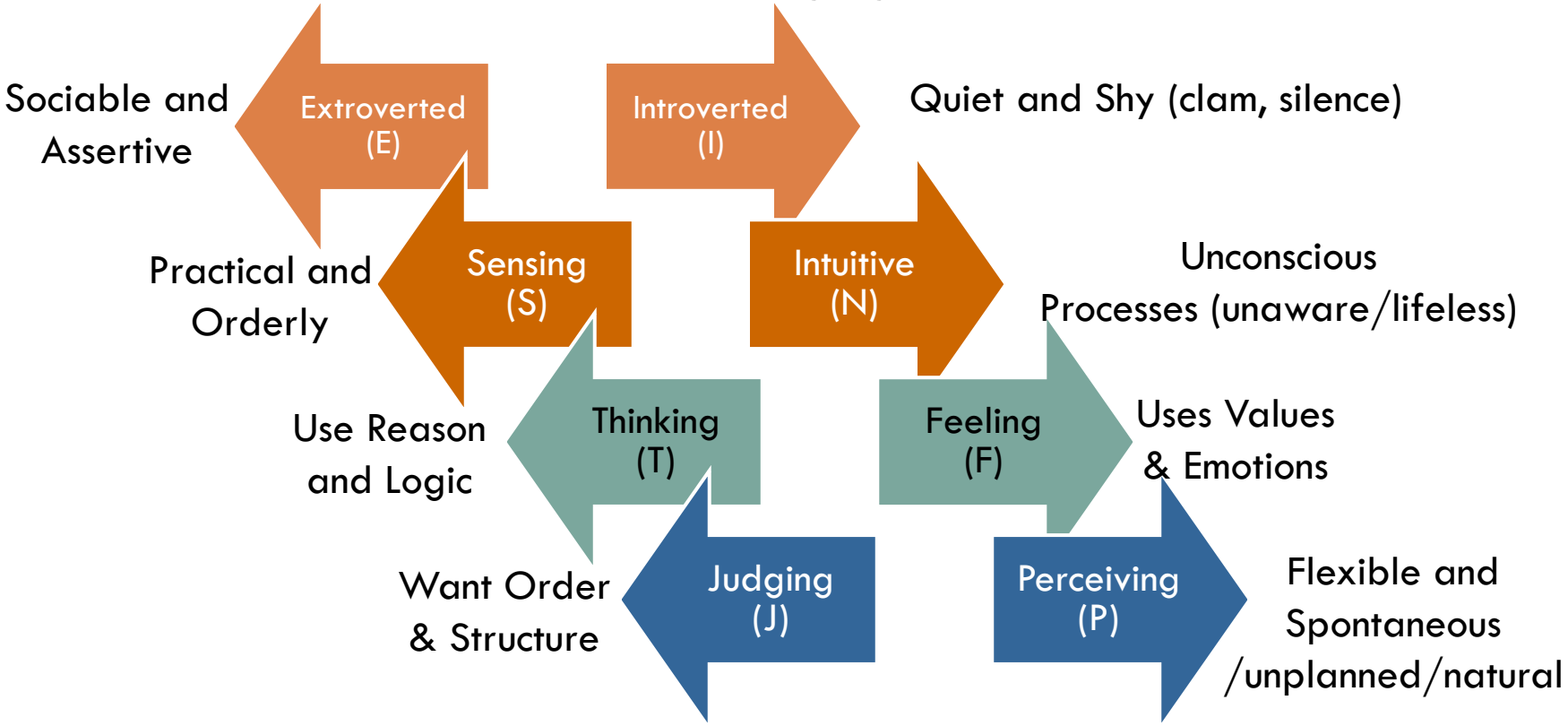
Enduring characteristics that describe an individual's behavior

- The more consistent the characteristic and the more frequently it occurs in diverse situations, the more important the trait.

- Two dominant frameworks used to describe personality:
  - Myers-Briggs Type Indicator (MBTI®)
  - Big Five Model

The Myers-Briggs Type Indicator (MBTI)

- Most widely used instrument in the world.
- Participants are classified on four axes to determine one of 16 possible personality types, such as ENTJ.



Sensing vs Intutive

- Sensing individuals focus on how their senses help them interpret information. Intuitive individuals think less about evidence and more about future possibilities.

The Types and Their Uses

- Each of the sixteen possible combinations has a name, for instance:
  - Visionaries (INTJ): original, stubborn, and driven (single Minded)
  - Organizers (ESTJ): realistic, logical, analytical, and businesslike
  - Conceptualizers (ENTP): entrepreneurial, innovative, individualistic, and resourceful

- Research results on validity mixed
  - MBTI® is a good tool for self-awareness and counseling.
  - Should *not* be used as a selection test for job candidates.

The Big Five Model of Personality Dimensions

Extroversion

- Sociable, gregarious(Social), and assertive (self Confident)

Agreeableness friendliness

- Good-natured, cooperative, and trusting

Conscientiousness (carefulness)

- Responsible, dependable, persistent, and organized

Emotional Stability

- Calm, self-confident, secure under stress (positive), versus nervous, depressed, and insecure under stress (negative)

Openness to Experience

- Curious, imaginative, artistic, and sensitive

There is a lot of research that supports the Big Five model and it has been shown to predict behavior at work.

- *Conscientiousness.* The **conscientiousness** dimension is a measure of reliability. A highly conscientious person is responsible, organized, dependable, and persistent. Those who score low on this dimension are easily distracted, disorganized, and unreliable.
- *Emotional stability.* The **emotional stability** dimension taps a person's ability to withstand stress. People with emotional stability tend to be calm, self-confident, and secure. High scorers are more likely to be positive and optimistic and experience fewer negative emotions; they are generally happier than low scorers. Emotional stability is sometimes discussed as its converse, neuroticism. Low scorers (those with high neuroticism) are hypervigilant and vulnerable to the physical and psychological effects of stress. Those with high neuroticism tend to be nervous, anxious, depressed, and insecure.
- *Extraversion.* The **extraversion** dimension captures our comfort level with relationships. Extraverts tend to be gregarious, assertive, and sociable. They are generally happier and are often ambitious.[20] They experience more positive emotions than do introverts, and they more freely express these feelings. On the other hand, introverts (low extraversion) tend to be more thoughtful, reserved, timid, and quiet.
- *Openness to experience.* The **openness to experience** dimension addresses the range of interests and fascination with novelty. Open people are creative, curious, and artistically sensitive. Those at the low end of the category are conventional and find comfort in the familiar.
- *Agreeableness.* The **agreeableness** dimension refers to an individual's propensity to defer to others. Agreeable people are cooperative, warm, and trusting. You might expect agreeable people to be happier than disagreeable people. They are, but only slightly. When people choose organizational team members, agreeable individuals are usually their first choice. In contrast, people who score low on agreeableness are cold and antagonistic.

Exhibit 5-2 Model of How Big Five Traits Influence OB Criteria

BIG FIVE TRAITS	WHY IS IT RELEVANT?	WHAT DOES IT AFFECT?
Emotional stability	• Less negative thinking and fewer negative emotions • Less hypervigilant	• Higher job and life satisfaction • Lower stress levels
Extraversion	• Better interpersonal skills • Greater social dominance • More emotionally expressive	• Higher performance • Enhanced leadership • Higher job and life satisfaction
Openness	• Increased learning • More creative • More flexible and autonomous	• Training performance • Enhanced leadership • More adaptable to change
Agreeableness	• Better liked • More compliant and conforming	• Higher performance • Lower levels of deviant behavior
Conscientiousness	• Greater effort and persistence • More drive and discipline • Better organized and planning	• Higher performance • Enhanced leadership • Greater longevity

How Do the Big Five Traits Predict Behavior?

- *Research has shown this to be a better framework.*
- Certain traits have been shown to strongly relate to higher job performance:
  - Highly conscientious people develop more job knowledge, exert greater effort, and have better performance.
  - Other Big Five Traits also have implications for work.
    - Emotional stability is related to job satisfaction.
    - Extroverts tend to be happier in their jobs and have good social skills.
    - Open people are more creative and can be good leaders.
    - Agreeable people are good in social settings.

More Relevant Personality Traits

- Self-Monitoring
  - The ability to adjust behavior to meet external, situational factors.
  - High monitors conform more and are more likely to become leaders.

- Risk Taking
  - The willingness to take chances.
  - May be best to align propensities with job requirements.
  - Risk takers make faster decisions with less information.

Even More Relevant Personality Traits

- Type A Personality
  - Aggressively involved in a chronic, incessant struggle to achieve more in less time
    - Impatient: always moving, walking, and eating rapidly
    - Strive to think or do two or more things at once
    - Cannot cope with leisure time
    - Obsessed with achievement numbers
  - Prized in today's competitive times but quality of the work is low
  - Type B people are the complete opposite of Type A's
- Proactive Personality (Practical. Hands-on)
  - Identifies opportunities, shows initiative, takes action, and perseveres to completion
  - Creates positive change in the environment

Values

Basic convictions on how to conduct yourself or how to live a life that is personally or socially preferable – "How To" live life properly.

- Attributes of Values:
  - *Content Attribute*: that the mode of conduct or end-state is important
  - *Intensity Attribute:* just how important that content is
- Value System
  - A person's values rank ordered by intensity
  - Tends to be relatively constant and consistent

Importance of Values

- Provide understanding of attitudes, motivation, and behaviors
- Influence our perception of the world around us
- Represent interpretations of “right” and “wrong”
- Imply that some behaviors or outcomes are preferred over others

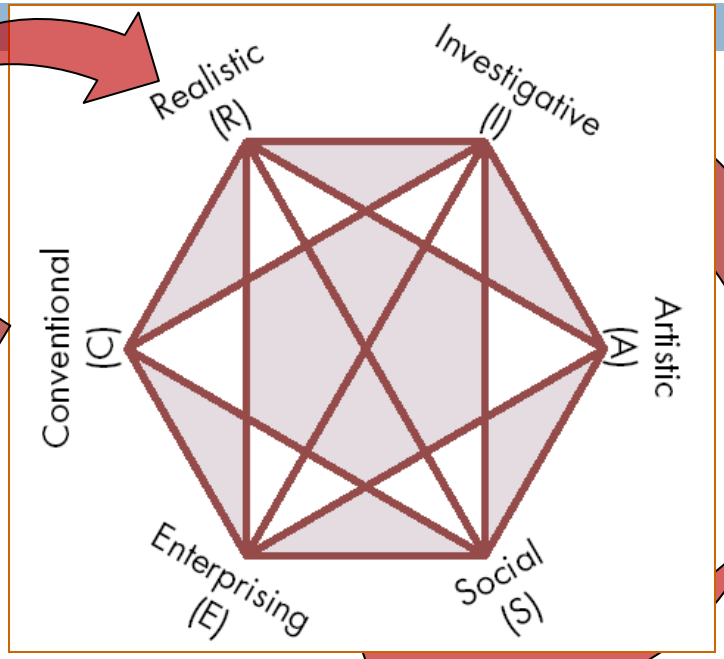
Linking Personality and Values to the Workplace

Managers are less interested in someone's ability to do a specific job than in that person's flexibility.

- Person–Job Fit:
  - John Holland's Personality–Job Fit Theory
    - The person-job fit theory developed by John Holland has been critical to thinking about how people fit with a specific job
    - Six personality types
    - Vocational Preference Inventory (VPI)
  - Key Points of the Model:
    - There appear to be intrinsic differences in personality between people
    - There are different types of jobs
    - People in jobs congruent with their personality should be more satisfied and have lower turnover

Relationships Among Personality Types

The closer the occupational fields, the more compatible.



The further apart the fields, the more dissimilar.

Need to match personality type with occupation.

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EXHIBIT 5-6

Holland's typology of personality and Congruent (matching) Occupation

Type	Personality Characteristics	Congruent Occupations
Realistic: Prefers Physical Activities that require skill, strength and coordination	Shy, genuine, persistent, conforming, practical	Mechanic, drill press operator, assembly line worker, farmer,
Investigative: Prefers activities that involve thinking, organizing and understanding	Analytical, original, curious, independent	Biologist, economist, mathematician, news reporter
Social: Prefers activities that involve helping and developing others	Sociable, Friendly, cooperative, understanding	Social worker, teacher, counselor, clinical psychologist

Holland's typology of personality and Congruent Occupation …

Type	Personality Characteristics	Congruent Occupations
Conventional: Prefers rule-regulated, orderly, and unambiguous activates	Conforming, efficient, understanding	Accountant, corporate manager. Bank teller, file clerk
Enterprising: Prefers verbal activates in which there are opportunities to influence others and attain power	Self-confident, ambitious, energetic, domineering	Lawyer, real estate agent, public relations specialist, small business manage.
Artistic: Prefers ambiguous and unsystematic activities that allow creative expression	Imaginative, disorderly, idealistic, emotional, impractical	Painter, musician, writer, interior decorator.

Still Linking Personality to the Workplace

In addition to matching the individual's personality to the job, managers are also concerned with:

- Person–Organization Fit:
  - The employee's personality must fit with the organizational culture.
  - People are attracted to organizations that match their values.
  - Those who match are most likely to be selected.
  - Mismatches will result in turnover.
  - Can use the Big Five personality types to match to the organizational culture.

Global Implications

- Personality
  - Do frameworks like Big Five transfer across cultures?
    - Yes, but the frequency of type in the culture may vary.
    - Better in individualistic than collectivist cultures.
- Values
  - Values differ across cultures.
  - Hofstede's Framework for assessing culture – six value dimensions:
    - Power Distance
    - Individualism vs. Collectivism
    - Masculinity vs. Femininity
    - Uncertainty Avoidance
    - Long-term vs. Short-term Orientation
    - Indulgence vs. Restraint

Hofstede's Framework: Power Distance

The extent to which a society accepts that power in institutions and organizations is distributed unequally.

- Low distance: Relatively equal power between those with status/wealth and those without status/wealth
- High distance: Extremely unequal power distribution between those with status/wealth and those without status/wealth

Hofstede's Framework: Individualism

- Individualism
  - The degree to which people prefer to act as individuals rather than as member of groups
- Collectivism
  - A tight social framework in which people expect others in groups of which they are a part to look after them and protect them

Hofstede's Framework: Masculinity

- Masculinity
  - The extent to which the society values work roles of achievement, power, and control, and where assertiveness and materialism are also valued
- Femininity
  - The extent to which there is little differentiation between roles for men and women

Hofstede's Framework: Uncertainty Avoidance

The extent to which a society feels threatened by uncertain and ambiguous situations and tries to avoid them

High Uncertainty Avoidance:

Society does not like ambiguous situations and tries to avoid them.

Low Uncertainty Avoidance:

Society does not mind ambiguous situations and embraces them.

Hofstede's Framework: Time Orientation

- Long-term Orientation
  - A national culture attribute that emphasizes the future, thrift, and persistence
- Short-term Orientation
  - A national culture attribute that emphasizes the present and the here and now

Hofstede's Framework: Indulgence

- Indulgence
  - The degree to which it is alright for people to enjoy life, have fun, and fulfill natural human desires
- Restraint
  - The extent to which there are social norms governing the gratification of basic human desires and behavior

Hofstede's Framework: An Assessment

- There are regional differences within countries
- The original data is old and based on only one company
- Hofstede had to make many judgment calls while doing the research
- Some results don't match what is believed to be true about given countries
- Despite these problems it remains a very popular framework

Best Jobs For Every Personality

ESTP

Pragmatists who love excitement and excel in a crisis.

1. Detective
2. Banker
3. Investor
4. Entertainment agent
5. Sports coach

ISTP

Straightforward and honest people who prefer action to conversation.

1. Civil engineer
2. Economist
3. Pilot
4. Data communications analyst
5. Emergency room physician

ESFP

Lively and playful people who value common sense.

1. Child welfare counselor
2. Primary care physician
3. Actor
4. Interior designer
5. Environmental scientist

ISFP

Warm and sensitive types who like to help people in tangible ways.

1. Fashion designer
2. Physical therapist
3. Massage therapist
4. Landscape architect
5. Storekeeper

ENTJ

Natural leaders who are logical, analytical, and good strategic planners.

1. Executive
2. Lawyer
3. Market research analyst
4. Management/Business consultant
5. Venture capitalist

INTJ

Creative perfectionists who prefer to do things their own way.

1. Investment banker
2. Personal financial adviser
3. Software developer
4. Economist
5. Executive

ENFJ

People-lovers who are energetic, articulate, and diplomatic.

1. Advertising executive
2. Public relations specialist
3. Corporate coach/Trainer
4. Sales manager
5. Employment specialist/HR professional

INFJ

Thoughtful, creative people driven by firm principles and personal integrity.

1. Therapist/Mental health counselor
2. Social worker
3. HR diversity manager
4. Organizational development consultant
5. Customer relations manager

THE BEST JOBS FOR EVERY PERSONALITY TYPE

We consulted the book "Do What You Are" and one of its authors, Paul Tieger, to determine five of the best jobs for each of the 16 Myers-Briggs personality types.

INTERACTION WITH WORLD

I — **INTROVERTS** often like working alone or in small groups, prefer a more deliberate pace, and like to focus on one task at a time.

E — **EXTROVERTS** are energized by people, enjoy a variety of tasks, a quick pace, and are good at multitasking.

ABSORPTION OF INFORMATION

S — **SENSORS** are realistic people who like to focus on the facts and details, and apply common sense and past experience to come up with practical solutions to problems.

N — **INTUITIVES** prefer to focus on possibilities and the big picture, easily see patterns, value innovation, and seek creative solutions to problems.

DECISION-MAKING

T — **THINKERS** tend to make decisions using logical analysis, objectively weigh pros and cons, and value honesty, consistency, and fairness.

F — **FEELERS** tend to be sensitive and cooperative, and decide based on their own personal values and how others will be affected by their actions.

ORGANIZATION

J — **JUDGERS** tend to be organized and prepared, like to make and stick to plans, and are comfortable following most rules.

P — **PERCEIVERS** prefer to keep their options open, like to be able to act spontaneously, and like to be flexible plans made.

E S T J

Realists who are quick to make practical decisions.

1. Insurance sales agent
2. Pharmacist
3. Lawyer
4. Project manager
5. Judge

I S T J

Hard workers who value their responsibilities and commitments.

1. Auditor
2. Accountant
3. Chief financial officer
4. Web development engineer
5. Government employee

E S F J

Gregarious traditionalists motivated to help others.

1. Sales representative
2. Nurse/Healthcare worker
3. Social worker
4. PR account executive
5. Loan officer

I S F J

Modest and determined workers who enjoy helping others.

1. Dentist
2. Elementary school teacher
3. Librarian
4. Franchise owner
5. Customer service representative

THEORISTS

Theorists love their work when they can come up with innovative new ideas and inventions.

ENTJ

Driven Directors

Executive
Engineer
Attorney
Architect

PHYSICIAN

INTJ

Strategic Masterminds

Software Developer
Technical Writer
Judge
Surgeon

MICROBIOLOGIST

ENTP

Inspired Inventors

Urban Planner
Entrepreneur
Producer/Director
Real Estate Agent

REPORTER

INTP

Independent Scientists

Software Engineer
Medical Scientist
Mathematician
Psychiatrist

COLLEGE PROFESSOR